Calix

MODULE 2

CHAPTER 7

The Agent Workforce Journey

Chapter 6 established that AI success is ultimately a leadership and change challenge. This chapter focuses on the single discipline that determines whether that change sticks: data quality — and the trust it creates at every stage of your agent journey.

Employees and customers ask good questions every day. In most cases, the answers already exist somewhere in your organization. For communication service providers, the opportunity is rarely about collecting more data — it is about making better use of what already exists. Agents are the bridge between questions and confident action. But when the information agents rely on is fragmented, inconsistent, or outdated, they don't solve problems. They scale them. When data is clean and connected, agents amplify good decisions that are faster and more consistent.

What do we mean by "clean data"? Clean data is accurate, complete, consistently formatted, and up to date. It means subscriber records that reflect reality, knowledge articles that aren't contradictory or stale, and business rules that are documented rather than tribal. Clean data is the difference between an agent that gives a confident, correct answer and one that confidently gives the wrong one.

What You'll Learn

- How data quality requirements evolve across the three stages of the Agent Workforce Journey
- Why each stage breaks down without intentional data discipline — and how to prevent it
- How the Calix Domain Agents are built to improve data quality as they are used
- How to build enrichment habits that support scale before you need them

The Agent Workforce Journey

The Agent Workforce Journey moves through three stages, and each one raises the bar for data quality. Think of it as climbing a staircase: each step up requires stronger data underneath. At the first step, poor data leads to a bad answer — a human catches it and moves on. At the second step, that same bad data triggers a bad action, repeated at automation speed. At the third step, it cascades across agents and departments before anyone notices. Skip the discipline early and you may still get a pilot off the ground — but you will not be able to scale it.

1 — Knowledge Assist

Answer the Question

Agents enable your marketing, support, and operations teams to find answers more quickly and learn faster. Instead of searching through outdated documents or waiting for a colleague, employees ask and get an immediate, grounded answer.

Data Enrichment
When knowledge sources are accurate and current, agents deliver consistent answers. Every thumbs-up/down interaction surfaces gaps and drives continuous improvement.

Employee Experience
Teams stop searching and start asking. New hires ramp faster. Experienced staff spend less time answering the same questions repeatedly.

FOUNDATION

2 — Task Automation

Do this Task

Agents carry out tasks to meet defined goals and rules — resolving issues, building segments, triggering workflows — improving speed of execution and leveraging insights from past interactions.

Data Enrichment
When historical data is clean and rules are well-defined, agents resolve issues correctly the first time. Each resolved interaction becomes training data.

Employee Experience
Repetitive, low-judgment tasks are handled by agents. Staff focus on exceptions, escalations, and work that requires human judgment.

AUTOMATED

3 — Process Orchestration

Run this Process

Agents react to events, anticipate needs, and coordinate with other agents to complete complex tasks autonomously — across departments, systems, and workflows.

Data Enrichment
When data definitions are consistent across domains, agents hand off cleanly to one another — enabling fully autonomous cross-system workflows.

Employee Experience
Staff shift from executing processes to overseeing them. They intervene on exceptions. Agents handle the rest.

ENTERPRISE-SCALE

Key point: The organizations that invest in data quality habits at Stage 1 are the ones that will be ready to operate at enterprise scale by Stage 3. Those that wait will find themselves rebuilding foundations under pressure.

Meet Your Calix Agent Workforce

Imagine having an infinite number of knowledgeable employees working seamlessly 24x7 on behalf of you and your customers. That's the promise of the Calix Agentic Workforce — not a collection of isolated tools, but a coordinated system of agents that share context, hand off decisions, and act in the best interest of the subscriber at every turn.

The Calix Agent Workforce brings together agents aligned to key functions within the broadband business, each focused on a distinct set of outcomes. While every agent group has deep functional expertise, they deliver the greatest value when operating as a connected team that acts proactively, consistently, and in the best interest of the customer.

Domain Agents

Knowledge assist and task automation within Engagement, Operations, and Service Cloud

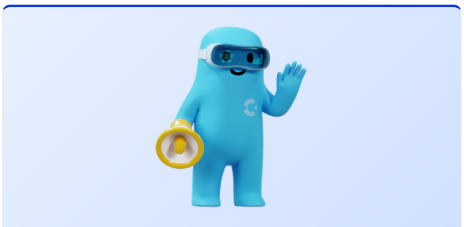
MARKETING AGENT | OPERATIONS AGENT | SERVICE AGENT

Agent-to-Agent

COMING SOON

Business process workflow automation with cross-domain agent-to-agent orchestration

CAMPAIGN BUILDER | CROSS-SELL & UPSELL | OUTAGE MANAGEMENT | CHURN PREVENTION



ENGAGEMENT CLOUD

Marketing Agent

Equip marketers with accurate, grounded answers and guided help to accelerate adoption and execution.

Key Capabilities

- Answers feature, KPI, and filter definition questions and how-to queries
- Starter prompts help new marketers get moving quickly
- Responses grounded in approved documents — no invented answers
- Allows upload of BSP-specific knowledge
- Thumbs-up/down feedback loop continuously improves the knowledge base

OPERATIONS CLOUD

Operations Agent

Help Operations team members answer questions on systems, processes, and the network to assist in troubleshooting and testing.

Key Capabilities

- Runs natively within Calix Operations Cloud
- Leverages Cloud knowledgebase content and BSP-uploaded documentation
- Natural language prompts replace complex search queries
- Thumbs-up/down feedback loop drives continuous improvement

SERVICE CLOUD

Service Agent

Boost CSR expertise and productivity with contextually specific answers to accelerate resolution and increase subscriber loyalty.

Key Capabilities

- Domain-based AI agent delivers contextually specific, guardrailed answers
- Upload your own knowledge articles for continuous enrichment
- Thumbs-up/down feedback loop improves accuracy over time
- Natural language prompts simplify the CSR experience
- Guardrails prevent hallucinations and out-of-scope responses

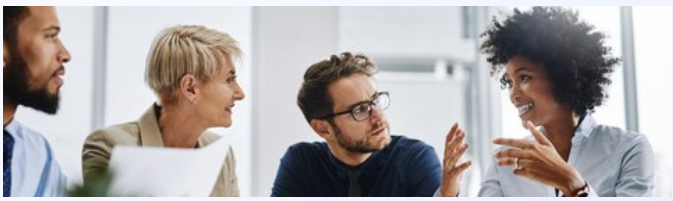
Knowledge Enrichment

On Day 1 of any agent implementation, your knowledge base is at its weakest. This is not a failure — it is how agent systems work. They are designed to learn and improve through use. But only when they are fed accurate, current, and well-structured knowledge. Without intentional enrichment, agents learn faster from outdated information, amplifying the very problems you hoped they would solve.

Key insight: Think of knowledge enrichment not as a one-time cleanup project, but as an ongoing discipline — like maintaining a garden. The work is never done, but the rewards grow with each passing season.

Effective Enrichment Practices

Building a sustainable knowledge enrichment process does not require massive infrastructure or specialized teams. It requires commitment to a handful of simple, repeatable practices that prevent confusion from creeping back in and ensure agent outputs remain credible as usage expands.



1

Clear Ownership of Key Data Domains

Assign named owners for each critical knowledge area. When everyone is responsible, no one is responsible. Ownership creates accountability and ensures someone is actively watching for drift.

2

Simple Naming and Documentation Standards

Establish consistent conventions so that knowledge articles, data fields, and processes are easy to find and understand. Complexity is the enemy of adoption.

3

Lightweight Monthly or Quarterly Review Cadence

Schedule regular check-ins to verify accuracy, retire outdated content, and surface gaps. A short, recurring review beats an annual overhaul every time.

4

Freshness Dates and Archiving Policies

Tag content with "last verified" dates and set clear rules for when material should be reviewed, updated, or removed. Stale information is worse than no information—it erodes trust.

Chapter 7 Takeaway

Data quality is one of the few levers every organization can fully control. The Agent Workforce Journey — from Knowledge Assist to Task Automation to Process Orchestration — only delivers its promise when data quality keeps pace at every stage. Treat knowledge enrichment as an ongoing leadership discipline, not a technical chore, and each stage of agent maturity will compound the last.

In the next chapter, we will explore how to measure AI progress and demonstrate ROI — giving your leadership team the evidence it needs to sustain momentum and justify continued investment.